



## **Interactive** - *Explanation of the motivations behind the design.*

**Title:** Drifting Topologies

**Student Name:** Christian Kenechukwu Anene

My project, ***Drifting Topologies***, is an interactive and rule-based ambient performance created with Free sound Explorer. I chose this tool because it gives me a lot of freedom to move, listen, and make decisions in real time, while keeping a clear structure for the performance. Many other Free sound tool list are either too automatic or too limited, but Free sound Explorer allows me to explore sounds in a way that feels open and creative. It shows sounds on a large map, and each dot is a different sample. This visual layout makes it easy to move through different sound textures and create a performance that feels like travelling through a landscape.

I decided to work in an ambient style because ambient sound works well with slow movement, gentle transitions, and simple rules. Ambient music does not need a beat or a strong rhythm. Instead, it focuses on atmosphere and texture. This fits perfectly with the way Free sound Explorer works, because the tool encourages drifting from one sound to another rather than building a traditional musical structure. The idea of “**drifting**” became central to the piece, and it inspired the title *Drifting Topologies*.

The rules I designed help guide the performance without making it feel mechanical. I wanted the rules to be easy to follow but still able to create interesting changes in the sound. For example, I created rules based on the length of the sound: short sounds lead to more clicks in the same area, while long sounds require a pause. I also added rules based on the texture of the sound. If a sound is soft and ambient, I stay in the same cluster. If it is noisy or harsh, I move to a different region. These rules help shape the performance and make sure it keeps evolving.

I also included time-based rules, such as moving to a new region every twenty seconds. This prevents the performance from staying in one place for too long. I added a small element of randomness by using a die to choose the starting region. This idea was inspired by chance-based methods used by artists like **John Cage**. The randomness makes each performance slightly different, but the rules keep everything connected and coherent.

**The limitations** of Free sound Explorer also influenced my design. The tool does not allow detailed editing of the sounds, such as changing pitch or adding effects. Instead of seeing this as a problem, I used it as part of the creative process. It encouraged me to focus on listening carefully and responding through movement rather than technical control. This made the performance feel more like

exploring a natural environment than producing a traditional piece of music.

Overall, *Drifting Topologies* is a performance that combines simple rules, personal interaction, and ambient sound exploration. It reflects my interest in how structure and freedom can work together, and how digital tools can create new ways of performing sound. The piece is not about creating a beat or a song, but about guiding attention, movement, and listening through a set of clear and meaningful rules.